The Regent’s Canal

1 The Regent’s Canal runs through Hackney, past Broadway Market and Victoria Park. Next to the water there is a path, called the towpath, where you can walk or ride a bike. It is free and open all the time, and it is one of the most peaceful places in the borough.

2 On the canal you will see narrowboats – long, thin boats painted in bright colours. Some people live on these boats all year. You will also see ducks, swans and sometimes a heron standing very still in the water.

3 The towpath is narrow, so be polite. Cyclists should ride slowly and ring their bell when they come up behind people. Walkers should keep to one side. Do not feed bread to the ducks – it is bad for them. On a sunny afternoon, it is lovely to walk all the way from Hackney to Islington.

Questions

Answer on your own first. Then check with your group and find the line in the text that proves each answer.

1. What can you do on the towpath?

A swim B walk or cycle C buy food D drive a car

2. Which sentence is correct?

A All the boats are grey.
B Some people’s homes are on the canal.
C The towpath is very wide.
D You must pay to use the towpath.

3. What should cyclists do?

A go fast
B go at a low speed and use their bell
C ride in the middle of the path
D get off and walk

4. Why should you not give bread to the ducks?

A It is expensive.
B It is unhealthy for them.
C The swans eat it.
D It is not allowed on Sundays.

5. Write two birds you can see on the canal.

1. _____

2. _____

Now write the answers for your place in your row of the grid.

E3 Reading – Hackney Places – Information grid

Name: _____ 1. Fill in your own place. 2. In your new group, listen to the experts and fill in the other three places. Ask questions!

Place	Where is it?	What can you do or buy there?	Does it cost money?	When is a good time to go?	Two adjectives that describe it
A Ridley Road Market					
B London Fields and the Lido					
C Broadway Market					
D The Regent's Canal					

Useful language: It's in / near … You can … It's free. / It costs … The best time to go is … It's very … and …